

Tweaks for the power user

Solve common niggles, tweak your UI, and get things done quicker, smarter, and in a more efficient way.

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Geeks like to get under the hood and get their hands dirty, right? At the same time if there is a smarter way of doing things who wouldn't want to use it? In this section we show you some quick hacks that anyone can implement, to get more out of your system and keep it running as good as new.

70 SAY GOODBYE TO .DLL ERRORS

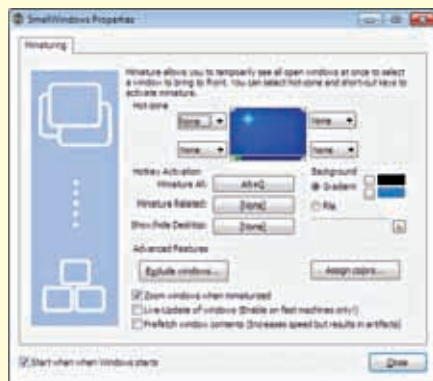
Often, if a perfectly good piece of software stops working suddenly, chances are the error is the result of a .dll file that's gone bad. A fix for this is to go to sites like <http://www.dll-downloads.com/> that have repositories of thousands of .dll files, search the one you want and install it. Installing is a simple process too. Dump the .dll file in `c:\windows\system32`. To register the file hit [Win] + [R] and type "regsvr32 filename.dll".

71 MANAGE DESKTOP CLUTTER IN A JIFFY

There are two tools you can use for this. One is called Belvedere (Download: <http://bit.ly/dbelvedere>) and the other is Deskretary (<http://bit.ly/deskretary>). Belvedere can be used as a behind-the-scenes automated clean up tool, that will regularly clean/organise up your desktop. While Deskretary can be an end of the month push button solution to clean up the desktop after a month's accumulation. For Belvedere start by clicking on the plus [+] button to add rules for cleanup. In Deskretary you start with a wizard the first time the application launches.

72 GET MAC-LIKE BEHAVIOUR ON WINDOWS

While [Alt] + [Tab] works fine enough, it doesn't provide the eye candy of Mac's Exposé which brings to focus all win-



dows currently open. Even the Windows Flip 3D [Win] + [Tab] doesn't match up to its functionality. So what do you do? Go to <http://bit.ly/smallwindows> and download SmallWindows. Once installed double click on the taskbar icon to change settings. The only setting you really need to change is the keyboard combo. We set it to [Alt] + [Q] because it's right next to [Alt] + [Tab].

If you're altogether in love with OS X, you could also try out this skinning option called Snow Transformation Pack (<http://bit.ly/stp15>) which will make your Windows 7 look like the Snow Leopard. Just run the .exe as administrator.

73 CALIBRATE TEXT AND COLOUR

If you find yourself squinting at text, you probably need to execute this tweak. Hit [Win] + [R], type "dccw" and press [Enter]. This will launch the calibration utility. Click Next and use sliders to make adjustment. Choose the option that looks the best at each stage.



74 LOCK FOLDERS

There are many folder locking software out there, but most

of them have some bug or the other. Either too heavy, too many restrictions on the free version, or easily detectable, etc. Lock-a-folder (<http://bit.ly/lock-a-folder>) on the other hand is lightweight, free and leaves no trace in processes. Download > Set Master Password > Lock (upto three folders).

75 TAKE YOUR DESKTOP WHEREVER YOU GO

Take your desktop with you, wherever you go with by installing MojoPac [Find on DVD or <http://bit.ly/dmojopac>]. Install software and games onto a USB stick or any storage such device having MojoPac and simply use them on any laptop/PC/Netbook as soon as you plug in the USB drive. It has many other uses too. For example by installing MojoPac on your iPod and installing iTunes on it, you can directly import music from any computer.

76 SYSTEM MAINTENANCE TWEAKS

If you're someone who installs a lot of software and not necessarily always in a virtualised environment (such as <http://www.sandboxie.com/>), cleaning registry and hard-uninstalling software is something that would help keep things running smooth. CCleaner (<http://bit.ly/ccleaner>) is a good balance between user-friendly and advanced user features. RevoUninstaller (<http://bit.ly/drevouninstaller>) should take care of your uninstalling needs while a defrag using IObit's FastDefrag (<http://bit.ly/dsmartdefrag>) will help you quite a bit in speeding up performance.

77 ACCESS THE HIDDEN MASTER-LIST

Create a new folder on your desktop and call it Master-List. {ED7BA470-8E54-465E-825C-99712043E01C} The folder icon will change and when you open it, you will find every option that you can ever need

to tweak your system. Though these settings can be accessed through a maze of menus and sub-menus under control panel, it's really convenient to have them